



Horizon x DeVry

STRATEGIC AUDIT

May 2026

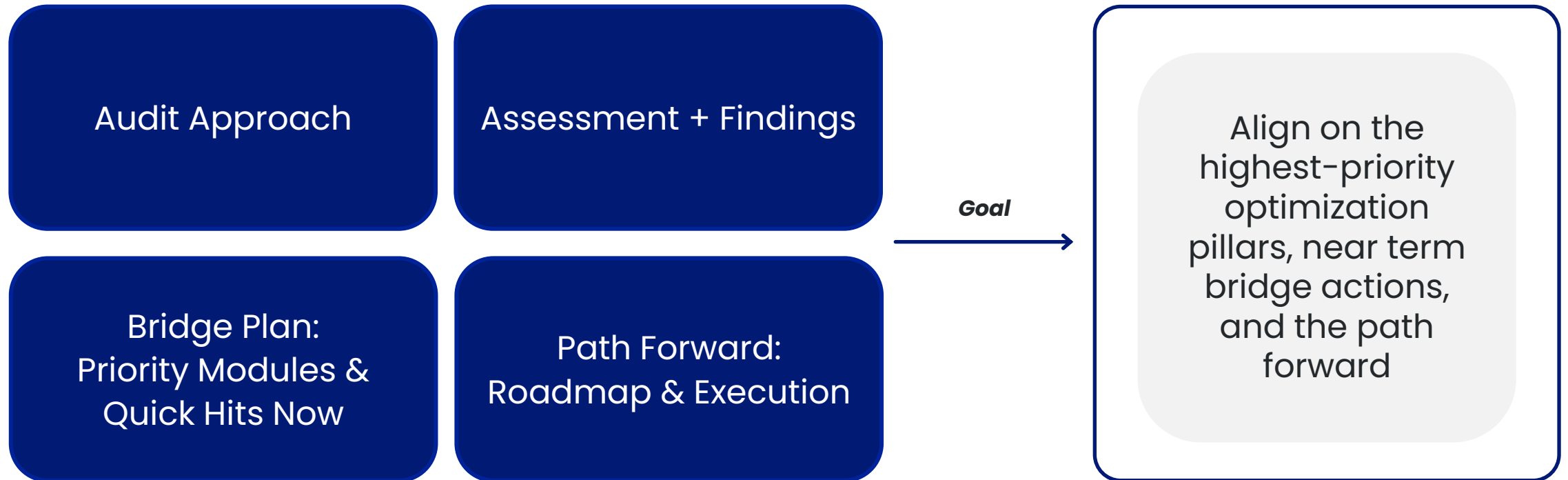


WHY WE'RE **HERE TODAY**

We're here to assess the industry landscape, competitive benchmarks, and DeVry's current site performance to **identify the most impactful opportunities to strengthen the customer journey, improve conversion, and align on the priority actions & path forward coming out of the audit.**



What We'll **Cover**



Our Approach

Our End-to-End Approach for Unlocking Conversion Growth



Goals and KPIs

- Confirm primary conversion goals and funnel definitions (visit to inquiry, inquiry to next action).
- Align on success metrics and guardrails by stage (engagement, form progression, completion, lead quality proxies).
- Flag measurement dependencies that affect readouts and testing.



External Assessment

- Evaluate against industry trends, shifts in consumer behavior & emerging best practices
- Assess consumer sentiment through social listening
- Benchmark DeVry experience against core competitors



Internal Performance Assessment

- Analyze performance by area of study and program where available.
- Review mobile vs desktop behavior and conversion gaps.
- Assess form progression and drop-off points, including visibility and usability issues.



DeVry Program Pillar Creation

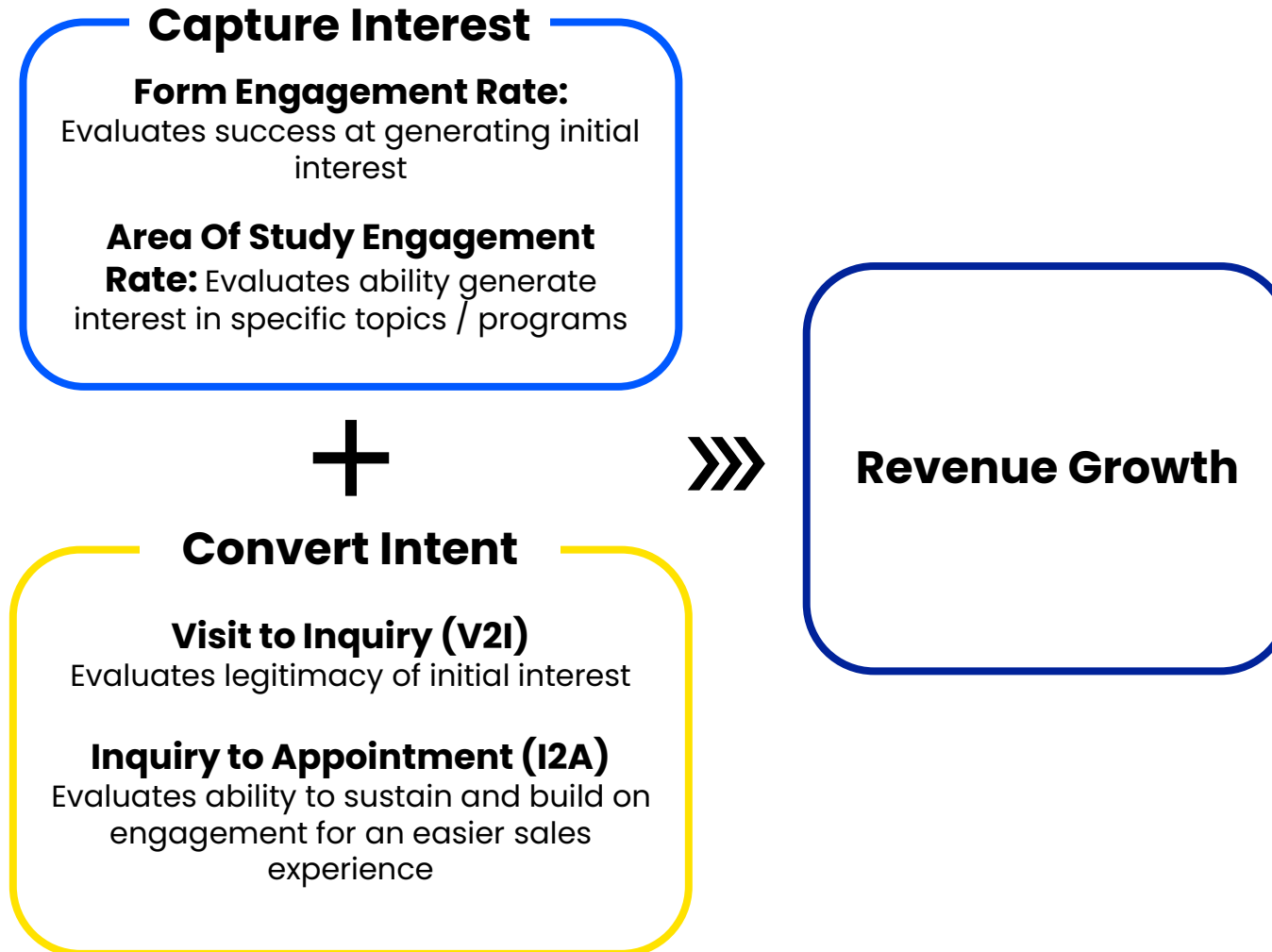
- Outline test ideas based on audit findings
- Identify consensus problems as strategic pillars for optimization



Test Concepting & Road Mapping

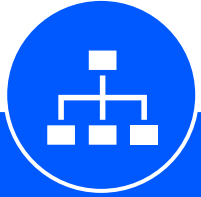
- Prioritize ideas, collaboratively refine them through joint brainstorming
- Build a finalized pipeline based on impact, dependencies, & scope

Strategic Audit Uncovers Impactful & Testable Opportunities To Drive Growth With Clear Execution Path



Our Assessment

Journey Breakdowns Are Eroding Enrollment Opportunity



Lack of Information Hierarchy

Undecided visitors are lost before they ever reach proof or form intent



Unclear Value Props & Credibility

Users hesitate because trust and payoff aren't earned before the ask



Arduous Lead Capture

High-intent is getting stranded by friction and low-intent never gets nurtured into intent



No Lead Nurture Post-Inquiry

Downstream value remains under-captured even after an inquiry is won

Benchmarking DeVry By Pillar: Today & Potential After 1 Year

01

Information Hierarchy

- Topic discovery content (Basic)
- Topic-based pathing (Basic)
- Program-specific content (Moderate)
- Program pathing (Moderate)
- Outcome pathing (Moderate)
- Recommendations (Sophisticated)
- Guided journeys (Sophisticated)

Score

DeVry today



With optimizations



Industry



02

Value Props & Credibility

- Online modality (Basic)
- Stackable pathways (Basic)
- Career outcomes (Moderate)
- Cost transparency (Moderate)
- Tailored emphasis (Moderate)
- Value calculator (Sophisticated)

Score

DeVry today



With optimizations



Industry



03

Lead Capture

- Form urgency (Basic)
- Field filtering & pre-fill (Moderate)
- Mobile optimization (Moderate)
- Need-based inquiry (Sophisticated)
- Guided upper-funnel capture (Sophisticated)

Score

DeVry today



With optimizations



Industry



04

Lead Nurture

- Positive consultation framing (Basic)
- Clear expectations (Basic)
- Post-inquiry freedom (Moderate)
- Lead prioritization data (Sophisticated)

Score

DeVry today



With optimizations



Industry



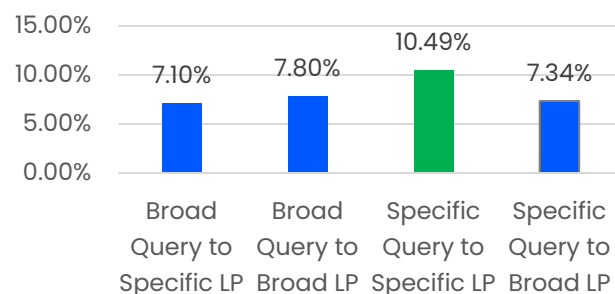
● Doing well ● Partial ● Gap

Progressive Discovery Converts Undecided Users Into Qualified Inquiries

Specificity Indicates Intent

When specific query intent matches landing page specificity, V2I improves by +44% and broad content for broad queries by +10% -- matching works, and specificity indicates intent

V2I By Query & LP Mapping



Most Users Don't Know What They Want (At First)

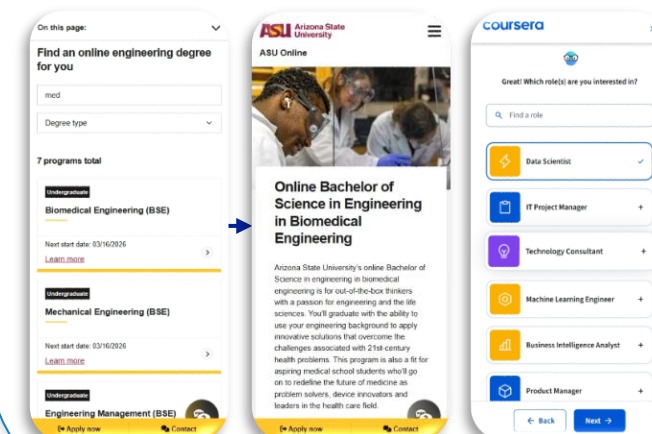
41% of paid spend targets queries without clear level or pathway – the experience then asks users to choose without specific context

[illegible]

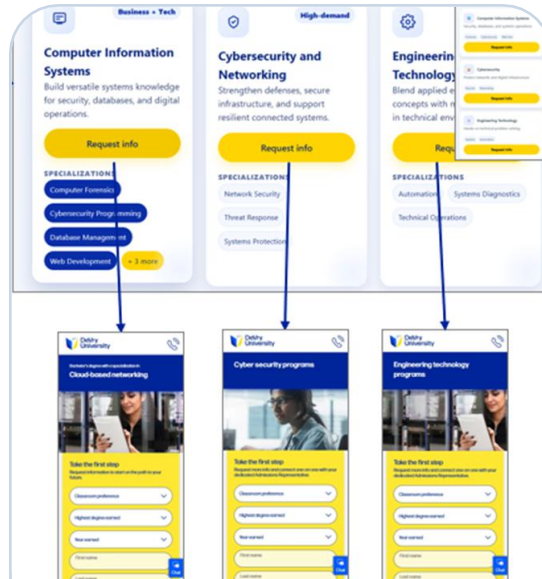
**+43%
CVR**
when specific
query →
specific LP*

Competitors Guide Discovery, Rather than Gate It

ASU and Coursera use quiz-style
pathfinders and topic → program
flows to move undecided users
toward specific programs without
forcing premature decisions

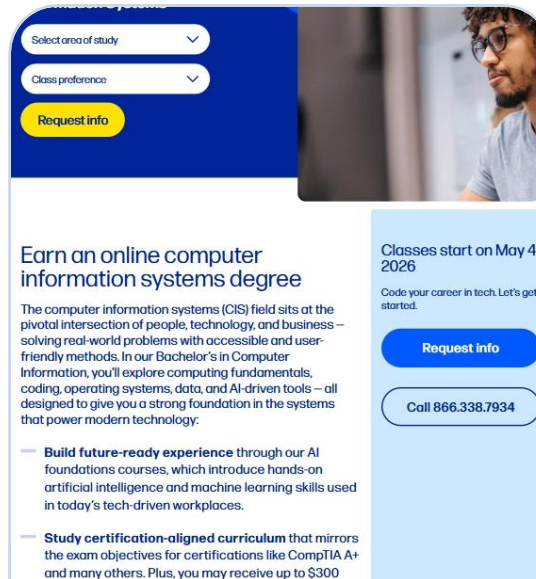


Optimization Opportunities: Topic & Career Goal Pathing Enable Progressive Discovery



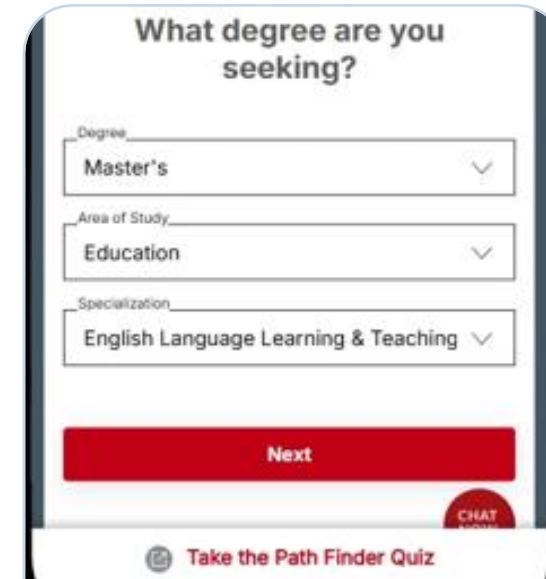
PROGRESSIVE PATHING

Improved content discovery enables users to progress from high-level interests to targeted programs, reducing friction through focused specialization paths and streamlined navigation



SPECIFIC PROGRAM DISCOVERY

Enabling user discovery all the way to their exact program of interest avoids halting exploration and produces high quality leads



GUIDED USER PATHS

Guided pathfinders reduce decision burden for undecided users, especially when decisions are put into user terms like role-based discovery

Proof Must Earn Trust Before The Ask – Outcomes, Cost, And Flexibility Drive Enrollment



Career Outcomes Are The Primary Driver

Competitors make skills, tools, and outcomes easy to scan; DeVry does not yet provide the hands-on proof, curriculum clarity, or employer cues tech users rely on to validate value and commit

***94%**

of online learners enroll for career outcomes

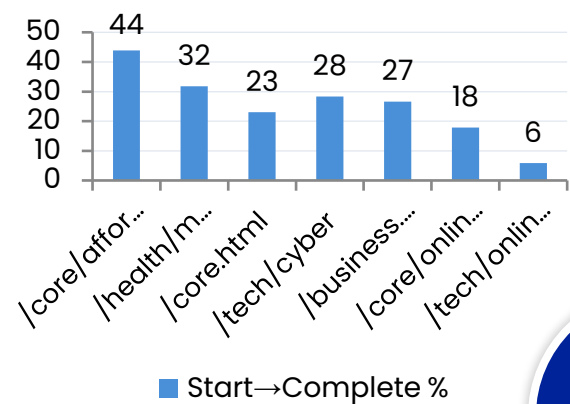
17%

of DeVry Reddit posts discuss outcomes justifying cost



Cost Clarity Is A Measurable Conversion Lever

Returning adults need early cost-to-value reassurance; competitors provide it up front, while DeVry delays tuition context—despite affordability page form delivering **+43.9%** higher completion rates



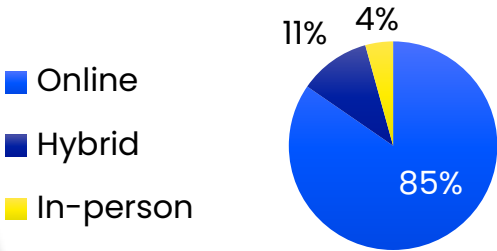
Affordability Page
+44% CVR



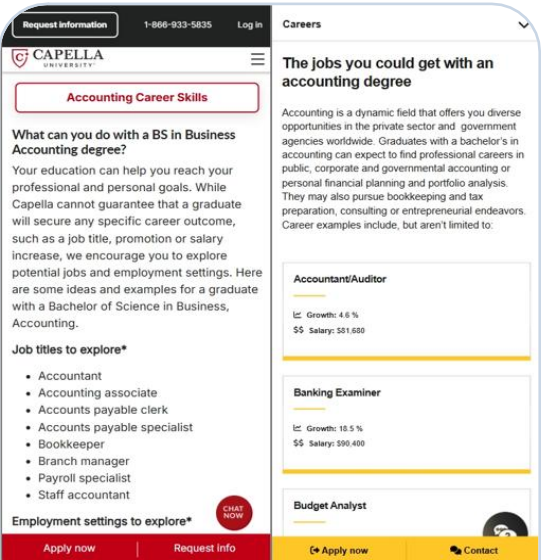
Stackable Pathways + Online Modality Lower The Inquiry Barrier

Students are ****2.4x** more likely to enroll when programs offer stackable credentials, yet despite **96%** of DeVry inquiries preferring some online modality, this preference isn't visually reinforced

% of Sessions With Selection

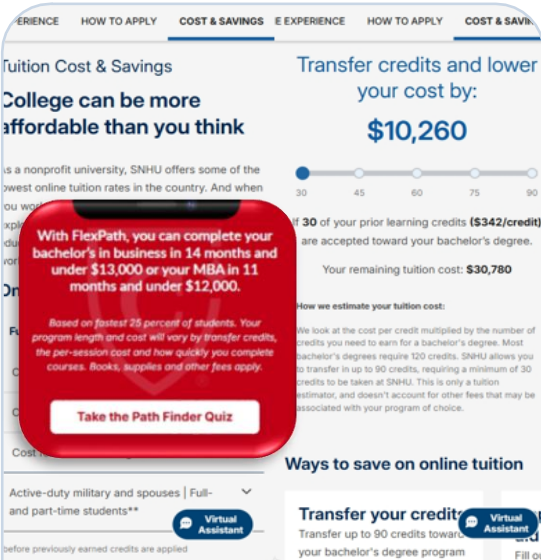


Optimization Opportunities: New Modules Address User Concerns For High-Friction Decision



CAREER OUTCOMES SNAPSHOT

Career outcomes signal meaningful value aligned to user goals, making specific DeVry skills and outcomes more compelling than institutional attributes alone



COST + AID CLARITY

Pricing clarity builds confidence in decision-making; higher education is inherently expensive, and hiding costs doesn't change what users already know



STACKABLE PATHWAYS

Stackable pathways mitigate commitment & completion concerns and re-assure value as credits complete



ONLINE RE-ASSURANCE

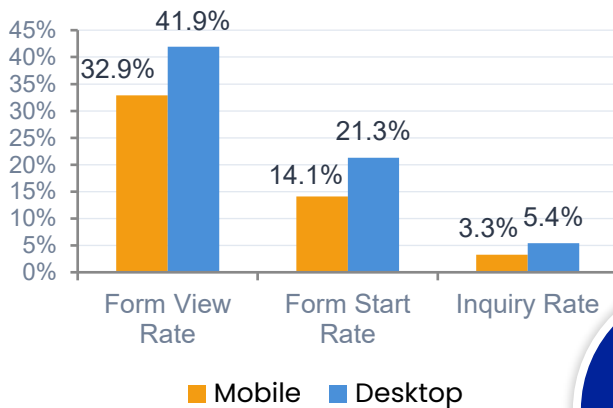
Busy students prioritize flexibility in how, where, and when they learn, making online delivery an important value proposition to reinforce—even if it doesn't drive modality selection

A Condensed Form Places Urgency In View While Pathing Users Toward Desired Enrollment



Massive Mobile Form

A single step mobile form occupies substantial real estate and prevents users from engaging with content that takes them from awareness (query + click) to intent (inquiry)



Mobile
Inquiry Rate
(vs desktop)
-40%



Unknown Enrollment Dates

"Every 8 weeks" allows delay while enrollment dates create urgency with deadlines



Difficult Form UX

Competitors streamline selection with pre-filtered, searchable dropdowns and focus on users' desired degrees rather than past education

Degree Level
Bachelor's

Class Setting
Online

Area of Study
Business

Program
BS in Accounting

Optimization Opportunities: Testing Mobile Experiences to Reduce Friction at the Moment of Intent

MULTI-STEP MOBILE FORM

Multiple steps reduce overload and encourage scrolling for content engagement

ENROLLMENT DEADLINES

Enrollment deadlines create urgency and encourage immediate action from high intent search users

Page	V2 Lift +/-	Stat Sig
Accounting	+17.31%	Yes
AI	-7.27%	No

SMOOTH SELECTION

Program selection should focus on user intent—reducing effort with pre-fill and search, and minimizing confusion through 1:1 field mapping and filtered, relevant programs

ALTERNATIVE FORMS

Forms that path users to appropriate programs via value exchange can capture leads for nurture ahead of inquiry

Enabling Continued Action Post Inquiry With Clear Next Steps Maintains Momentum



Immediate Action Limited To Outreach

Competitors immediately enable multiple next steps after lead capture (call, chat, apply online, or explore programs), while DeVry primarily pushes calls or chats without tailored content or an online apply path

0.3%

inbound calls or chat rate on get-started/thank you

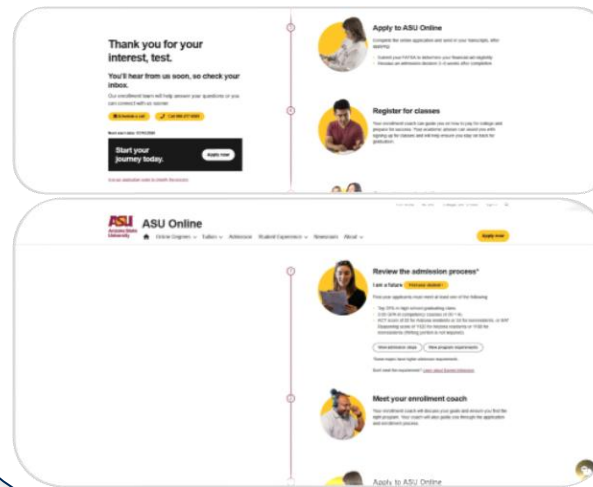
23.2%

main site 2nd Inquiry Rate



Unclear Next Steps

DeVry's success page lacks clear enrollment steps, missing an opportunity to motivate students and set clear expectations for what comes next



Undesirable Phone Call

Competitors streamline selection with pre-filtered, searchable dropdowns and focus on users' desired degrees rather than past education



Meet your enrollment coach

Your enrollment coach will discuss your goals and ensure you find the right program. Your coach will also guide you through the application and enrollment process.

Optimization Opportunities: Keep Leads Engaged & Clarify the Path Forward

Get familiar with your program

Before you enroll in a program, it's important to make sure it's a good fit for your career goals, learning style and budget. Look through the program details for information about required courses, admission requirements and learning outcomes. You can learn more about what to expect at Capella in our [University Guide](#).

[See program details](#)

CHAT NOW

ENCOURAGE EXPLORATION

Enrollment and tailored program exploration CTAs keep users engaged while they wait for a call

2 Enrollment consultation

Meet with an enrollment expert to discuss goals, program fit, and what happens next.

1:1 support

Guided next steps

- Review your goals and timeline
- Explore program and funding options
- Get clear answers before moving forward

OUTLINE PROCESS

Outline enrollment process steps and make them feel manageable

PRIORITIZE WITH DATA

Use readiness data to signal where leads likely are in their journey, validate journey stage, and prioritize outbound dialers accordingly

New Hampshire University. At SNHU, we're committed to helping you earn your degree faster (and for less money). Soon an admission counselor will reach out to you to:

- Discuss your goals and help match you to the right degree or certificate program
- Explore maximizing your transfer credits from previous colleges
- Determine if you're eligible for credits from military or work experience
- See if you qualify for military, employer or other partner tuition discounts
- Identify affordable tuition funding options, including grants, loans and payment plans

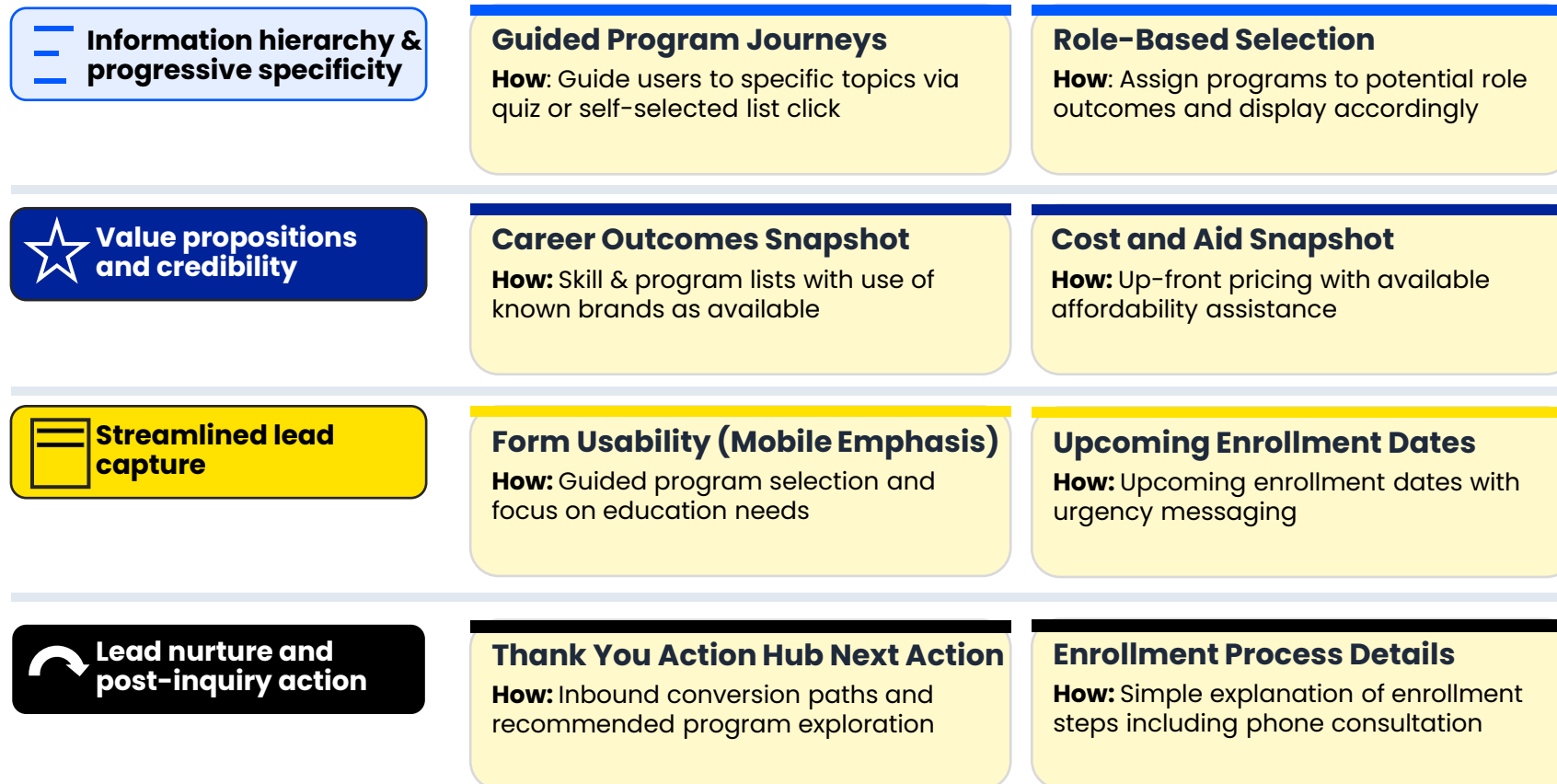
RE-FRAME THE CALL

DeVry should clearly communicate the benefits of its enrollment concierge and position it as a value-added support service—not just a process step

Capitalizing On Deeper Data Usage & Search Advancements

	CURRENT	ADVANCED
Information Hierarchy	• Surface information relevant to users based on query and on-site engagement • Guide users toward more application-ready inquiries with progressively targeted content to meet education goals	• Deliver tailored re-marketing content around prior visit engagements and remarketing campaigns • Recognize 3P user attributes or campaign parameters such as journey stage to render relevant content
Value Props & Credibility	• Content delivery tailored to most relevant user concerns and topics of interest • Confirm program efficacy with success metrics and social proof	• Modify targeted value props for high-intent sessions • Surface modality modules for “community college near me” queries • Personalizations related to existing social / programmatic campaigns or Blu targets once in place
Lead Capture & Nurture	• Improve form UI with an emphasis on program of interest selection • Personalize form pathing • Educate post-inquiry with expectation setting and journey self-selection	• Persist data across channels & sessions with potential for tailored message sequencing • Data collection for integration into CRM and sales systems

Reusable Content Modules Map to 4 Experience Themes & Unlock Conversion Lift



Filtered LP Dropdowns

Lead Capture

Concept

Primary focus:

- Filter dropdown values to only programs relevant to the landing page content (/business-programs example on the right)

Rationale:

- This is a best practice live on GCU ([Link](#))
- Implementation is simple as it requires 1 line of CSS tied to relevant elements

Estimated 12M Impact If Winner: 252 Apps

Control

The control version of the landing page form displays a dropdown menu for 'Program of Interest' with the following options: Undergraduate, Undecided, Accounting & Finance, Business & Management, Cyber Security, and Computer Information Systems. The dropdown is highlighted with a red dashed border.

Experiment

The experiment version of the landing page form displays a dropdown menu for 'Program of Interest' with the following options: Undergraduate, Undecided, Accounting & Finance, Business & Management, Graduate, and Undecided. The dropdown is highlighted with a green dashed border.

Sticky Product Intent Capture

Information
Hierarchy

Concept

Primary focus:

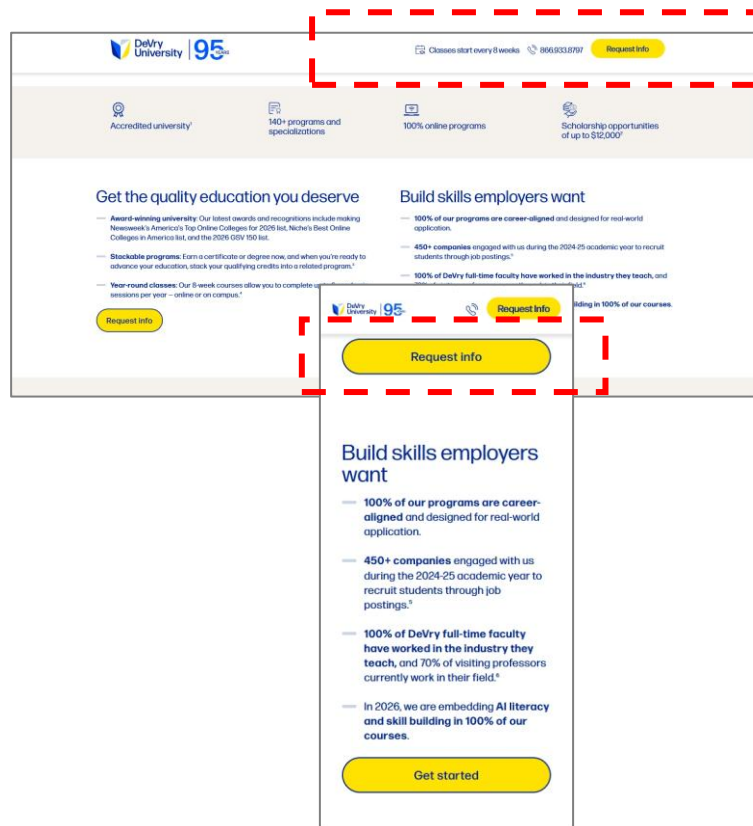
- Enable users to convert at the moment of intent with a sticky CTA that includes program of interest capture
- Ensure selection is passed as a pre-fill
- ABC as an anchor link on current page or linking to more specific page

Rationale:

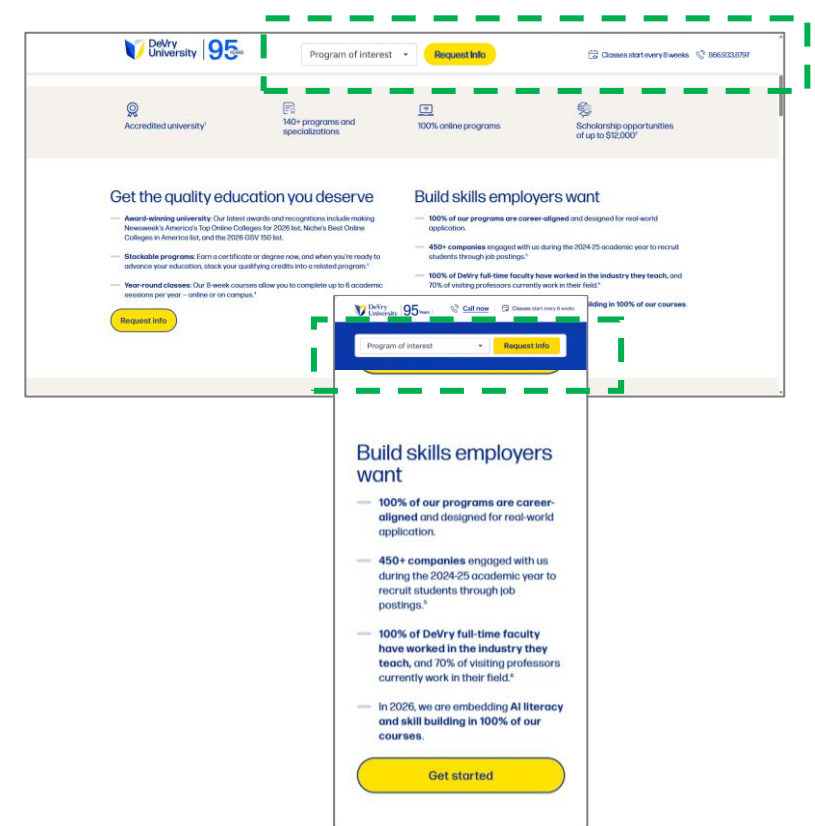
- This is a winning concept from other clients (11% primary KPI lift)
- Pre-selecting program of interest reduces requirements for engaging with a more complicated form

Estimated 12M Impact If Winner: 165 Apps

Control



Experiment



Content Progression Engages Researching Users

Information Hierarchy

Concept

Primary focus:

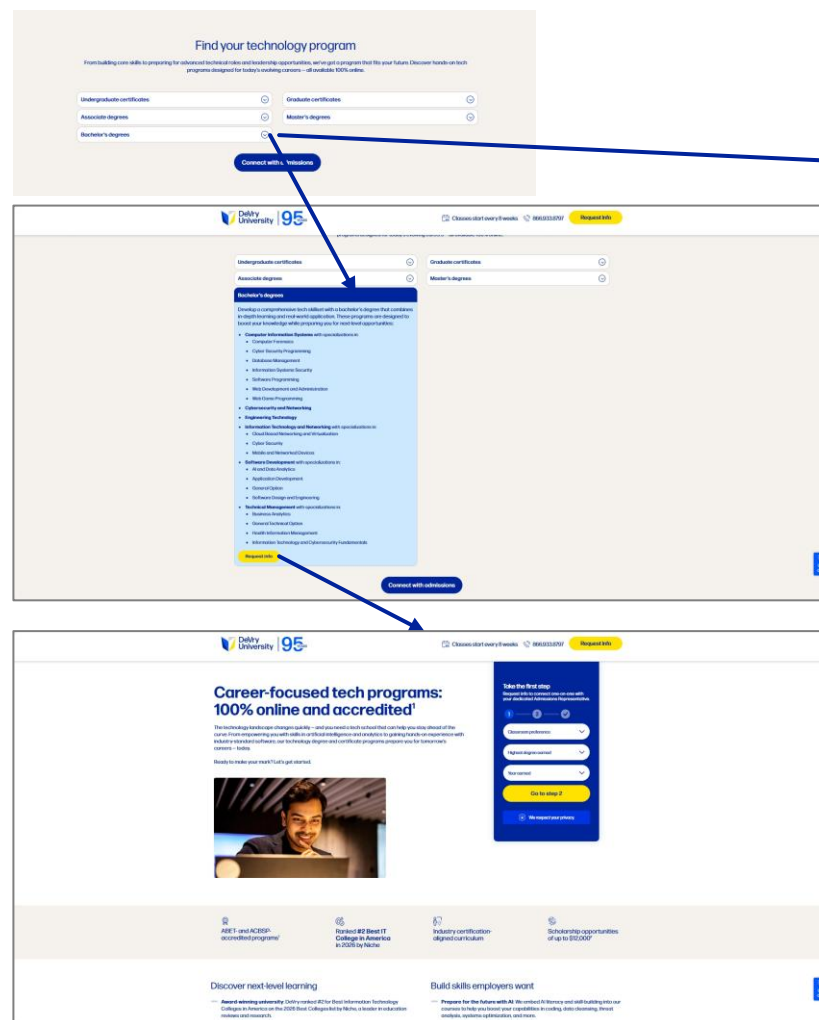
- On Higher level pages (Core, tech, business and health), link to the most relevant specific topic page to engage researching users in the upper funnel with progressive learning and avoid frustration and abandonment

Rationale:

- Progressive specificity is in place on major competitors like ASU ([Link](#)), University of Phoenix ([Link](#)) in a similar hierarchy, Colorado State ([Link](#)) and Walden ([Link](#))
- Specific queries to specific LPs convert 44% better than specific queries to broad LPs

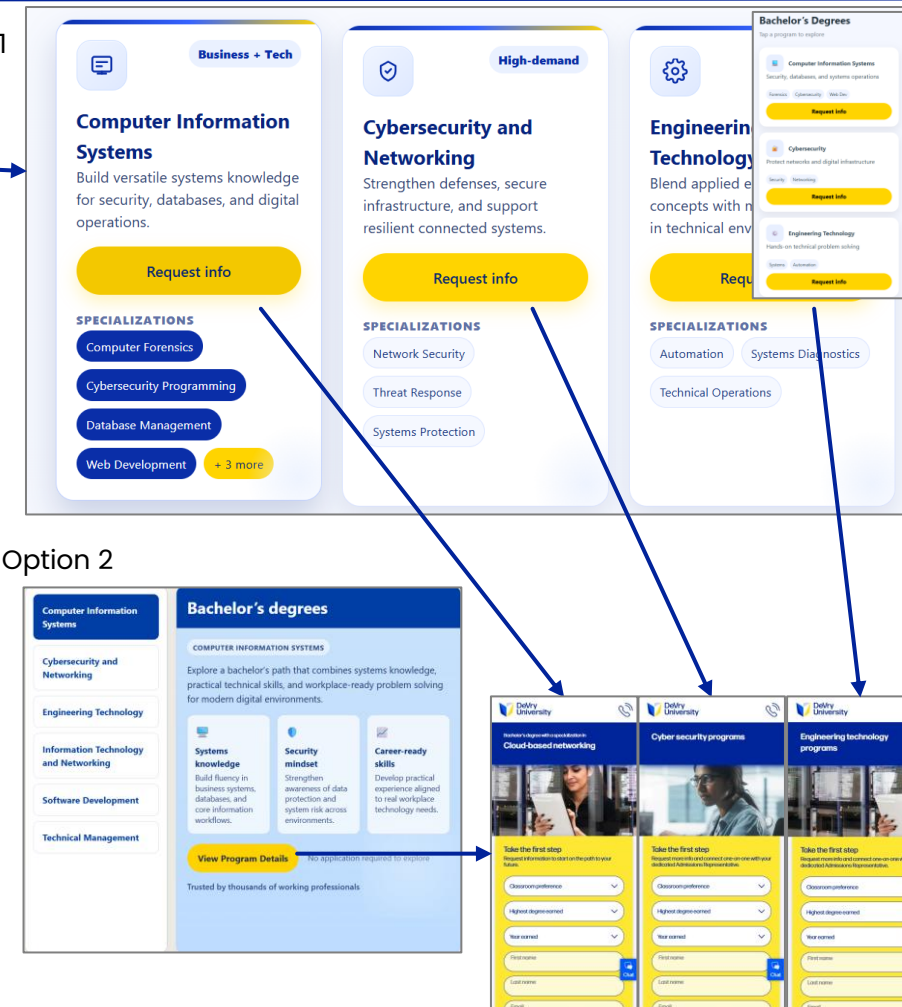
Estimated 12M Impact If Winner: 351 Apps

Control



Option 1 (reco)

Experiment



Option 2

Outcome-Based Pathing

Information Hierarchy

Concept

Primary focus:

- Re-frame the path selection conversation around outcomes rather than degrees to simplify decisions

Rationale:

- This is in place on Coursera ([Link](#))
- Career-first progression matches how prospects think about education decisions by starting with an outcome and removing the complexity around which degree pairs with desired outcome

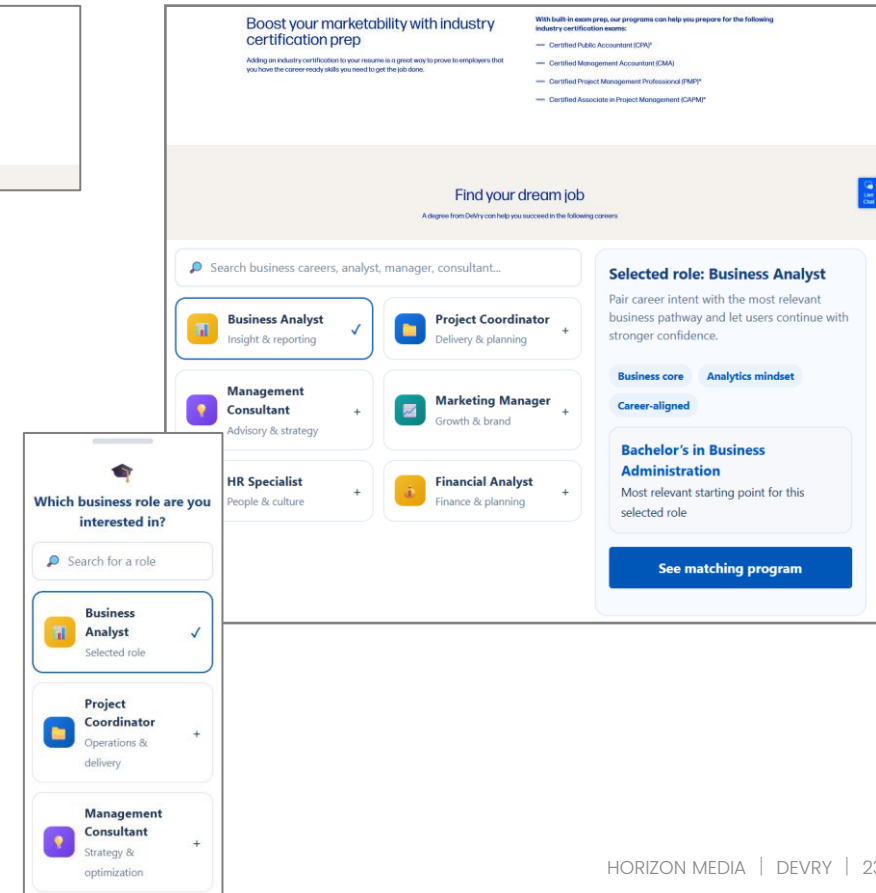
Follow-ups:

- Average position salaries and field growth as seen on ASU ([Link](#)) or SNHU ([Link](#))
- Comparison feature with multi-select functionality
- Embedded recommended path quiz

Control



Experiment



Repeat Online Availability

Value Props &
Credibility

Concept

Primary focus:

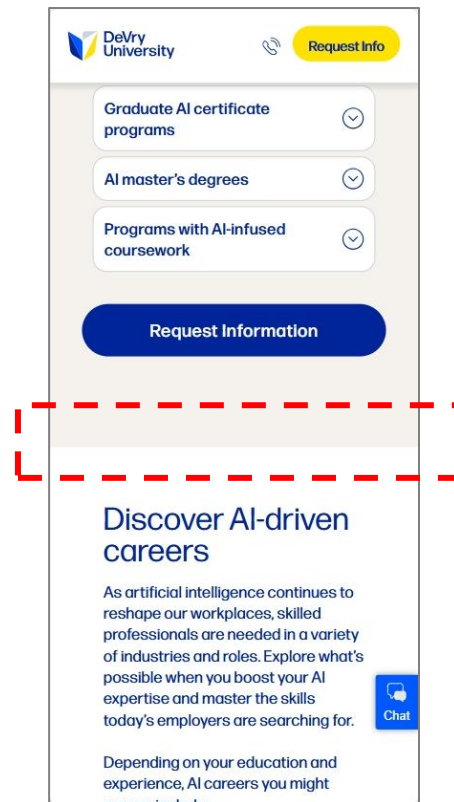
- Online and flexible learning modalities are an important value-add and should be reinforced with more than a single mention, especially around decision points (CTAs)

Rationale:

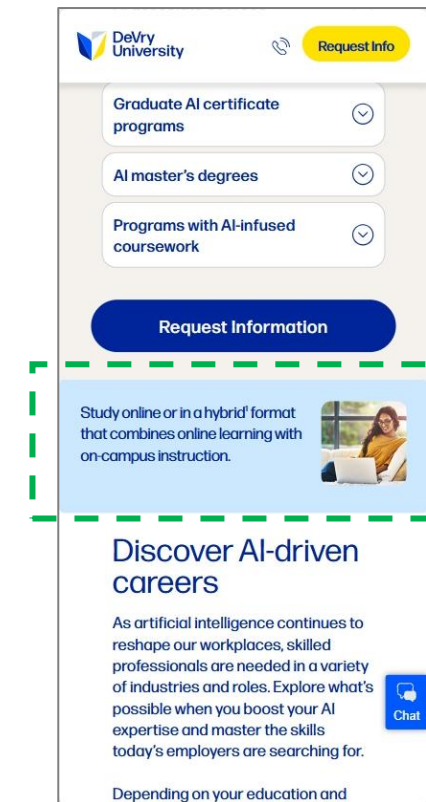
- ~25% of 2025 search spend was on keywords containing some variation of "online"
- 71% of adult learners require online modality but 73% still enroll in a school with in-state presence: [Link](#)
- 96% of users on DeVry selected online or hybrid modality: [Link](#)
- Re-use of module that fits into new template makes concept low lift

Estimated 12M Impact If Winner: \$475K

Control



Experiment



Enrollment Dates Create Urgency (ABC or Multivariate)

Lead Capture

Concept

Primary focus:

- Create enrollment urgency by communicating the next date classes start

Rationale:

- Urgency is a commonly winning tactic across ecom and lead gen: [Link](#)
- Colorado Tech uses clear enrollment dates to create urgency: [Link](#)
- Copy changes and simple module insertions make concept low lift

Estimated 12M Impact If Winner:
125 Apps

Control

The control form features a blue header with the DeVry University logo and a yellow 'Request Info' button. Below the header, the text 'Secure your future with AI courses and degrees' is displayed above a photo of two students. A red dashed box highlights the top section, which includes the text 'Classes Start Every 8 Weeks' and a phone number '866.933.8797'. Below the photo, another red dashed box highlights a section titled 'Take the first step' with a form containing four input fields: 'Classroom preference', 'Highest degree earned', 'Year earned', and 'First Name'. A 'Chat' button is located at the bottom right of the form.

Experiment

The experiment form is similar to the control but includes a green dashed box around the top section, which now displays 'Classes Start March 1, 2026'. A new green dashed box highlights a section titled 'March session enrollment closes in 09 days : 12 hours : 17 mins : 30 secs'. Below this, the text 'Get the quality education you deserve' is followed by three bullet points: 'Award-winning university', 'Stackable programs', and 'Year-round classes'. A yellow 'Request Info' button is located at the bottom right of the form.

Clearly Manageable Enrollment Process

Lead Nurture

Concept

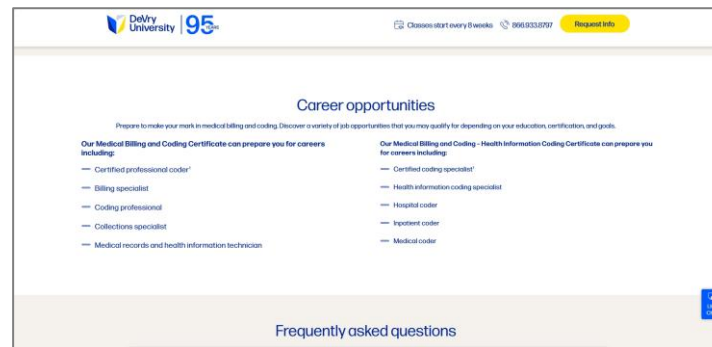
Primary focus:

- Set expectations that DeVry enrollment is manageable and assisted for the best outcomes

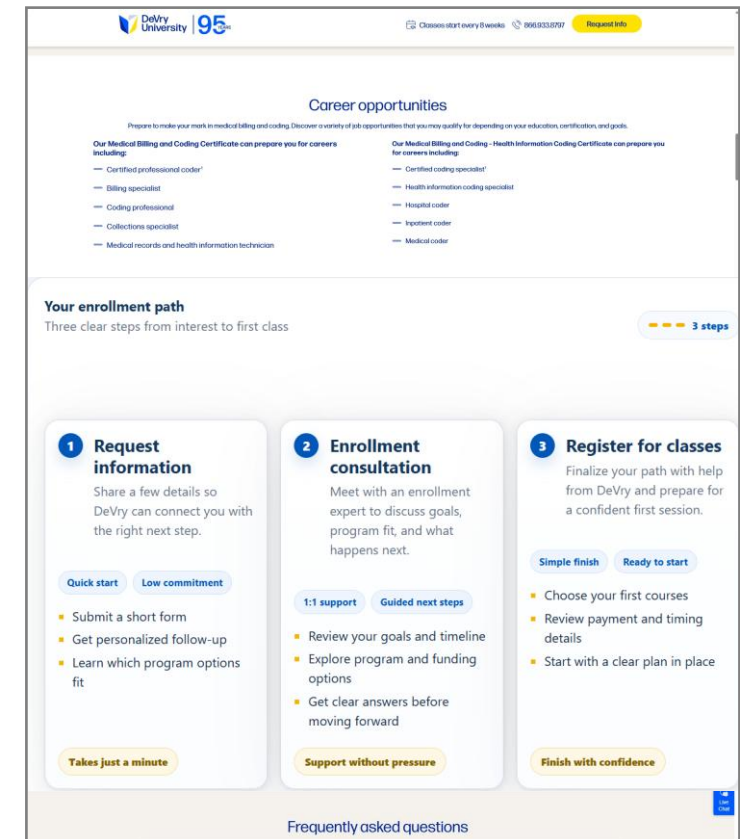
Rationale:

- This is in place on ASU ([Link](#))

Control



Experiment



Clearly Manageable Enrollment Process

Lead Nurture

Concept

Primary focus:

- Capture user communication preferences for (1) Ideal enrollment experience and (2) More effectively prioritized sales dialer

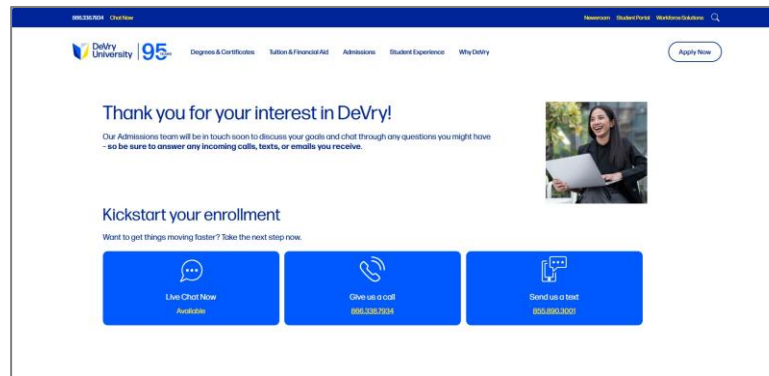
Rationale:

- More effectively engage interested parties by calling them sooner
- Improve sales consultant headcount efficiency by de-prioritizing users not interested in phone enrollment

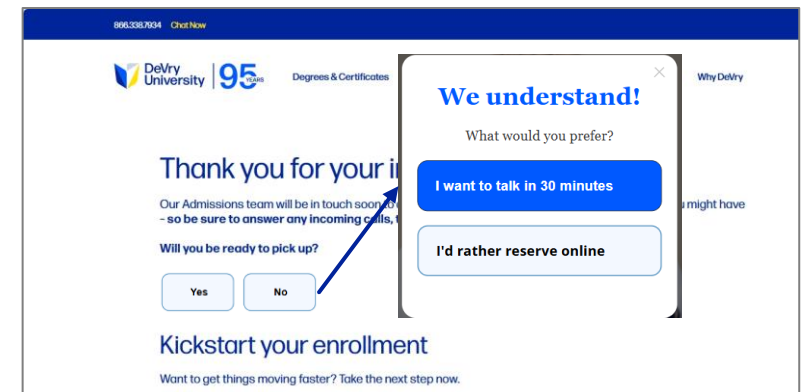
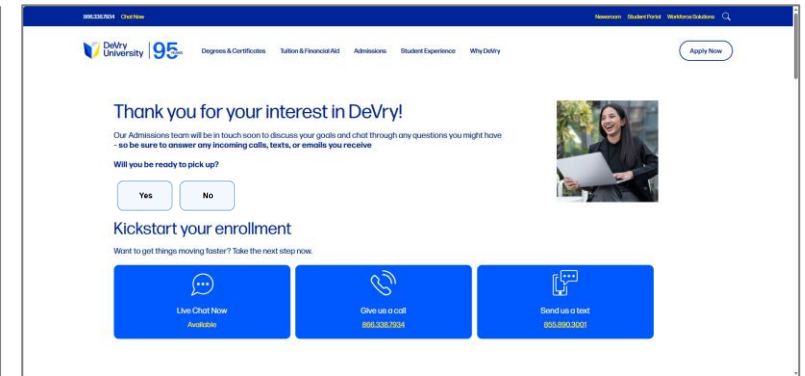
Follow-ups:

- Enhanced dialer segment prioritization after data collection
- Survey experience to understand why users select "No"

Control



Experiment



Discussion